DATA STORY / NUMBERS FIRST

A data story: change one judgment with one number

One number, one comparison, one conclusion.

Source → Compare → Conclude

SOURCES · BASELINE · ACTION

Conclusion first: one claim per slide

01

Judgment first, numbers second — this page argues exactly one thing.

Write the most important conclusion as the oversized headline.

The two paragraphs below carry the support: where the data comes from and why it should change your prior view.

SIGNAL / METRIC

72%

What does this number change?

Don't just show the number. Explain which judgment it changes and what the audience should do next.

SOURCE · PERIOD · SAMPLE

COMPARISON / VERSUS

Put both approaches under the same light

BASELINE

Existing approach

What it assumes, optimizes and where it breaks down. One fact per line, no judgments.

VS

PROPOSED

This work

Which assumption it drops and what that costs. Align item by item with the left column.

VERDICT

Verdict: under which conditions do you trust which side?

Three points that hold the story together

01
Transparent sourcing
State the sample, the window and the method; no black-box numbers.

02
Credible comparison
A number means nothing without a baseline; comparisons make it evidence.

03
Actionable conclusion
Every chart must land on a next action or decision.

TAKEAWAY / ONE SENTENCE

Let the numbers persuade so people can decide.

Next: replace placeholder figures and sources, then verify every definition.

END